Maddalena Totarelli

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ifo Institute
Economics of Education
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Research Fields Economics of Education, Labor Economics, Economics of Crime

Affiliations CESifo Research Network

Current Position

Postdoctoral Researcher, ifo Institute and LMU Munich — Sept 2025 -
Center for the Economics of Education

Education

University of Amsterdam, Netherlands — Sept 2021 - Aug 2025
Ph.D. in Economics
Advisors: Erik Plug and Giuseppe Sorrenti

Tinbergen Institute, Netherlands — Sept 2019 - Aug 2021
M.Phil. in Economics

Alma Mater Studiorum University of Bologna, Italy — Sept 2017 - July 2019
M. Sc. in Economics (*Summa cum Laude*)

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Italy — Sept 2014 - July 2017
B. Sc. in Business and Economics (*Summa cum Laude*)

Universidad Carlos III, Spain — Sept 2016 - Jan 2017
Erasmus+ Programme

Seminars and Conferences

2026 LESE Conference (Lisbon), ESPE (Helsinki), Junior Faculty Retreat (Munich)

2025 BHEPPE (Bologna), WEAI Conference (San Francisco), SOLE, EALE, and AASLE - Sixth World Labor Conference (Toronto), QPE Workshop King's College (London), ViCE (Online)

2024 Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime (Zurich), FAIR (Bergen), EALE (Bergen), EEA (Rotterdam), ESPE (Rotterdam), Counterfactual Methods for Policy Impact Evaluation (Amsterdam), BSE Summer Forum (Barcelona), Tinbergen Institute Jamboree (Amsterdam)

2023 Center for the Economics of Human Development (Chicago), AFE (Chicago), Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business (Düsseldorf), Field Days - Experiment Outside the Lab (Stavanger), WiP Microeconomics (Amsterdam)

2022 GEEZ Seminars (Online), PhD FEB Lunch Seminar (Amsterdam), IWAEE (Catanzaro), CAGE (Warwick), ESA (Bologna)

Research Visits

FAIR, Norwegian School of Economics — Sept 2024 - Oct 2024
Host: Professor Katrine V. Løken

CEHD, University of Chicago — Sept 2023 - Oct 2023
Host: Professor James Heckman

Publications

Reproducibility and Robustness of Economics and Political Science Research, Nature, 652(8108), 151-156.
(with Abel Brodeur et al.) Download paper.

Working Papers

Prison Rehabilitation Programs, Recidivism, and Labour Market Outcomes
Download paper.

Talent is Everywhere, Opportunity is Not: Online Role Model Mentoring and Students' Aspirations
(with Pietro Biroli, Amalia di Girolamo, and Giuseppe Sorrenti) Download paper.

Work in Progress

Children and Divorce
(with Petter Lundborg, Erik Plug, and Astrid Würtz Rasmussen)

Grants and Awards

A Sustainable Future research grant (PI) 2023, 10,000€
University of Amsterdam
Project: Prison Rehabilitation Programs, Recidivism, and Labor Market Outcomes

A Sustainable Future research grant (co-PI) 2023, 10,000€
University of Amsterdam
Project: From the Field to the Classroom: The Role of Sport in Fostering Children's Development and Well-being

Full Graduate Scholarships 2019-2021
Tinbergen Institute

Scholarship awarded to the top 5% of students 2018-2019
University of Bologna

Scholarship awarded to the top 5% of students 2015-2017
University of Rome Tor Vergata

Teaching Experiences

Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich
Lecturer, Economics of Education 2026-

African Fellows in Education Program, Nairobi, Kenya
Lecturer, Economics of Education Oct 2026

University of Amsterdam
Teaching assistant, Research Laboratory: Economics (undergraduate) 2022-2025
Teaching assistant, Natural Resources (undergraduate) 2022-2025

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam
Teaching assistant, Economics for the Global Era (undergraduate) 2020-2021
Teaching assistant, Quantitative Research Method (undergraduate) 2020-2021

Tinbergen Institute
Teaching assistant, Microeconomics I (graduate) 2020-2021

University of Bologna
Teaching assistant, Microeconomics (undergraduate) 2018-2019

Organization of Workshops and Conferences

Co-Organizer, Junior CESifo Conference on the Economics of Education 2026
CESifo, Munich

Co-Organizer, PhD FEB Lunch Seminar Series 2022-2025
University of Amsterdam

Referee Activities Journal of Population Economics

Skills
Programming: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, ArcGis
Language: Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (conversational), French (conversational), Dutch (basic), German (basic)

Professional Service

Chair of the PhD Council, University of Amsterdam	2022-2025
Works Council, University of Amsterdam	2023-2025
(Member of the Research, HRM, and Equal Treatment & Inclusivity Committees)	